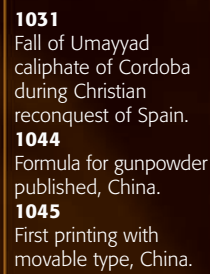
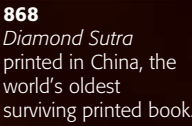
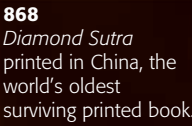
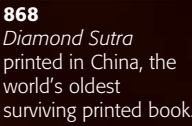


Few would have predicted that the states chaotically established across Western Europe after 600 CE by the barbarian successors to Rome would prove anything other than destabilizing. At least until 1000, Europe was clearly marginalized, an obvious backwater. China, rejuvenated by the Tang and later dynasties, was superior in every sense, a technological

powerhouse. Islam, legatee of ancient learning, explosively expansive, no less obviously imposed itself. Other societies—in the Americas, India, and Southeast Asia—promised much. Yet it was Christian Europe that would thrust itself upon the world. The process was never certain, but the results were decisive. Late-medieval Europe was poised to dominate the globe.

850		900		950		1000	
		878 Alfred, king of Wessex, defeats Danes at Battle of Edington to halt Danish advance in England.		c. 900 Beginning of golden age of Hindu temple-building in India. 906 Collapse of Tang dynasty, China. Magyars destroy Moravia (eastern Czech Republic) and begin to raid western Europe.		916 Foundation of Siberian Khitan empire, Mongolia 918 Foundation of state of Koryo in Korea.	
		c. 850 Arab navigators perfect astrolabe. Cholas under King Vijayalaya gain power in south India.		932 Election of Otto I as German emperor. 936 Abbasid caliphs in Baghdad lose effective power to their Turkish troops, the Mamluks.			
		c. 860 Cyrillic alphabet created in East Europe. 866 Vikings take city of York and establish a kingdom in northern England.		955 Otto I of Germany defeats Magyars at Lechfeld, halting their expansion west. 960 Song dynasty established in China. 966 Polish state founded by Mieszko I.			
		910 Foundation of reformed Benedictine abbey at Cluny, France. 911 Vikings found duchy of Normandy.		972 King Edgar crowned at Bath, uniting English kingdoms. Formation of unified Hungarian state under Duke Geza. 986 Erik the Red begins Viking settlement of Greenland.			
		967 Fujiwara clan begins unification of Japan. 969 Fatimids of Tunisia assume control of North Africa from Tunisia to Egypt and relocate to new capital, Cairo.		1000 Stephen crowned as first king of Hungary. 1008 First Muslim raids into northern India, led by Muhammad of Ghazni.			
		939 Kingdom of Dai Viet in Vietnam throws off Chinese rule. 947 Nomadic Qidan people invade northern China and establish Liao dynasty.		1013 Renewed Danish invasion of England. 1016 England, Denmark, and Norway united under King Canute.			
		1031 Fall of Umayyad caliphate of Cordoba during Christian reconquest of Spain. 1044 Formula for gunpowder published, China. 1045 First printing with movable type, China.		1047 Beginning of Norman conquest of southern Italy and Sicily. 1048 Fatimids lose control of Libya.		